

Distributing Without an Installer

Use the portable **win-unpacked** build or create a compressed ZIP package.

1 Build the app

Run the build command:

```
npm run dist
```

This creates a folder similar to:

```
dist/  
  win-unpacked/  
    Animate Asset Replacer.exe  
  resources/  
    ...other files
```

2 Create a ZIP file

The **win-unpacked** folder is already a complete portable version of the app. Keep all of its files together and compress the entire folder into a ZIP archive.

Windows: Right-click the win-unpacked folder and choose **Compress to ZIP file** (or Send to > Compressed folder on older Windows versions).

3 Share the ZIP

Distribute the ZIP through your website, cloud storage, an internal file share, email (if the size is reasonable), or a release/download service.

No installation is required. Users only need to download and extract the ZIP.

4 How users run it

After extracting the ZIP, users open the folder and double-click:

```
Animate Asset Replacer.exe
```

The app runs directly from the extracted folder.

5 Tips for a smooth experience

- Include a README.txt with basic instructions.
- Tell users to keep the app folder intact.
- Do not distribute only the .exe; Electron needs the accompanying files.
- Version the ZIP filename, for example **Animate-Asset-Replacer-v0.3.2.zip**.

! Windows SmartScreen

If the app is not code-signed, Windows may show a SmartScreen warning when another user downloads and runs it. Code signing is the normal way to improve trust/reputation for distributed builds.

This is separate from whether the app uses an installer; a portable executable can also trigger SmartScreen.

Summary: ZIP the entire dist/win-unpacked folder and share that ZIP. The recipient extracts it and runs Animate Asset Replacer.exe directly.